MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 2, Episode 13

"Brand New Day"

Episode 2x13. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 2x13 (the midseason premiere). Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Wednesday, January 11, 2006, 5:02 AM through 11:58 PM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 42 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-2x12

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on Wednesday, January 11, 2006). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Wednesday, January 11, 2006)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern (passed Step 2 CK)	Oct 25, 1979	26
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	26
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern	Feb 10, 1979	26
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	27
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	26
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (35 weeks 6 days pregnant)	Aug 29, 1977	28
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Dr. Bryce Kennerly	Surgical Intern (probation review)	Jun 11, 1978	27
Silas Tillman (new)	Patient: symptomatic, then ruptured, AAA	Sep 2, 1920	85
Corinthia Tillman (new)	Silas's wife of 60 years	May 15, 1923	82
Dr. Wendell Moseley (new)	Chief of Vascular Surgery	Aug 25, 1944	61
Keisha Bowman (new)	Patient: exertional rhabdomyolysis, bilateral compartment syndrome	Oct 9, 1967	38
Dr. Camille Toussaint	Orthopedic Resident	Jul 21, 1976	29
Darius 'Dash' Duvall	Patient: Status 1A, day 61	Aug 8, 1971	34
Glenda Duvall (new)	Dash's mother	Dec 12, 1947	58
Kamari Fields	Transplant recipient (discharged)	Apr 24, 1991	14
Nadine Fields	Kamari's mother	Aug 1, 1967	38
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Franklin Bassett, Esq.	General Counsel	Oct 28, 1958	47
Dr. Sylvia Rountree (on-screen debut)	President and CEO, Queens Grace Hospital	Dec 2, 1951	54
Dr. Horace Whitlow	Chief of Medicine	Sep 19, 1949	56
Lamont 'Monty' Gaines	Owner, Monty's on Jackson	Oct 10, 1962	43
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Dr. Abraham Lowery	Attending General Surgeon	Jan 9, 1947	59
Dr. Eugene Pratt (new)	Surgical Program Director	Nov 14, 1948	57
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	OB/GYN and Fetal Surgeon	Mar 3, 1971	34
Rev. Dr. Elias Montgomery (new)	Associate pastor, Abyssinian	Jun 30, 1937	68
Mercy	The House's pit bull puppy (about 4 months)	Sep 30, 2005	0

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Troy Daniels (new)	Spin instructor, Peak Fitness	Jul 19, 1974	31

Also appearing: Mr. Kostas (off-screen), a CT tech, an anesthesiologist, ICU and CVICU nurses, the Tillman family (two sons, a daughter and four grandchildren), Jamaica neighbors, a taverna waiter and a maintenance worker. Mentioned: Malcolm Sloan, Corinne Smilley, Dr. Joan Mercer, V.J. Donohue, Wanda Moseley (d. 2002), Russell Jeffries, a guard named Alphonse, and Augustin Toussaint.

COLD OPEN

1 INT. ARIANNA'S APARTMENT - ABOVE THE BAKERY - ASTORIA - PRE-DAWN
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 5:02 AM

The same small room. The same Pitt sweatshirt. The same Dell laptop, the same shrieking modem. Downstairs, the ovens are already going. Arianna (26) sits on the edge of the bed with her knees pulled up. On the screen: "USMLE STEP 2 CK -- SCORE REPORT AVAILABLE." Her finger hovers over the trackpad. She doesn't click.

She closes her eyes. She clicks. The page loads one line at a time.

"RESULT: PASS."

Below it, a three-digit number. Twenty-four points above the line.

Arianna doesn't move. Then she sets the laptop aside very carefully, lies back on the bed and stares at the ceiling. Downstairs, Mr. Kostas drops a sheet pan and swears in Greek. Arianna starts to laugh. She laughs until she's crying, both hands over her face.

MARC (V.O.)
Every January, the whole world makes the same promise.

2 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - RAVEN'S ROOM - PRE-DAWN
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 5:09 AM

Dark. A cell phone buzzes on the nightstand next to the red 30-day chip. Raven (26) fumbles for it, half asleep.

RAVEN
(groggy)
'Lo?

ARIANNA (V.O.)
(on the phone, trying to sound casual, failing)
Passed.

Raven sits straight up in bed.

RAVEN
(beat)
What?

ARIANNA (V.O.)
(beat)
I passed, Ellison. (beat) Twenty-four over.

Raven screams. Down the hall, a door bangs open, then another. Mercy, now four months old and much bigger, bursts through Raven's door and leaps onto the bed, barking.

MARC (V.O.)
A brand-new day. A clean page. This year, we'll be different.

RAVEN
(shouting into the phone)
You passed! (beat) She passed! (beat) Everybody, she passed!

HARMONY (O.S.)
(from the hallway)
Who passed?!

AMOND (O.S.)
(from the stairs, dry)
Problem passed. (beat) Go back to bed.

MARC (V.O.)
The trouble is, we bring last year with us. (beat) Every single time.

END OF COLD OPEN

ACT ONE

3 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - MORNING
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 6:04 AM

The Christmas decorations are gone, except for one paper star at the top of the kitchen window. Arianna has arrived with the score report printed out and slid into a plastic sheet protector. It sits in the middle of the table like a trophy. Harmony (26) makes celebration pancakes. Amond (26) reads the printout for the third time. Marc (26) feeds Mercy, who now has her own bowl stenciled "MERCY" in gold paint.

AMOND
(reading)
Twenty-four over. (beat)
Respectable.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Respectable?

AMOND
(setting it down)
For somebody who sleeps three hours a night and studies renal in a bakery. (beat)
Congratulations, Problem.

ARIANNA
(beat, touched despite herself)
Thank you, Baker.

RAVEN
(coming in, hugging Arianna from behind)
Dinner. Tonight. (beat) Seven o'clock. That Greek place on Ditmars with the octopus. (beat)
My treat.

ARIANNA
(beat)
You hate octopus.

RAVEN
(beat)
I hate it with you. (beat) That's different.

Harmony flips a pancake onto Arianna's plate.

HARMONY
(beat, to Marc)
So. (beat) Brookline. (beat) You've been back two weeks, and you still haven't told us anything. (beat) Thirty-one Donohues.

MARC
(beat)
Thirty-four. (beat) Some cousins came from Atlanta. (beat) My grandmother made Mercy her own plate. (beat) Turkey and rice. On the good china.

HARMONY
(beat)
Dr. Mercer fed your dog off the Donohue china.

MARC
(beat, dry)
My uncle V.J. asked if it was a rescue. (beat) Grandma said, "Everyone at this table is a rescue, Victor Junior."

Amond almost chokes on his coffee.

4 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - INTERNS' LOCKER ROOM - MORNING
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 6:38 AM

Marc changes. Esther (26), back from Boston for over a week now, comes in and opens the locker beside his. She's been avoiding this conversation since she got back. Today she isn't.

ESTHER
(low)
I need to tell you something before you hear it in the hallway.

MARC
(beat)
Okay.

ESTHER
(beat)
Christmas Eve. (beat) My mother's. (beat) Malcolm sat at the table. (beat) Rule one held. Nobody left. (beat) My mother made him say grace. (beat) He couldn't get through it.

Marc waits.

ESTHER
(beat)
Afterward, on the porch, he told me he's moving to New York. (beat) In February. (beat) He's been offered a job.

MARC
(beat)
At NYU?

ESTHER
(beat, very quietly)
Here. (beat) Head of Plastic Surgery. (beat) Queens Grace. (beat) Dr. Rountree's recruiting him. (beat) He interviewed in November. (beat) He didn't tell me until Christmas Eve.

Marc closes his locker slowly.

MARC
(beat)
Here.

ESTHER
(beat)
Here. (beat) In this building. (beat) With my husband. (beat) And me.

MARC
(beat)
What did you say to him?

ESTHER
(beat)
I said, "Pass the sweet potato pie, Malcolm." (beat) Then I went upstairs and threw up in my sister's bathroom.

5 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - NURSES' STATION - MORNING
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 6:56 AM

The interns gather. Elxa (28), 35 weeks and 6 days pregnant and enormous, sits on her stool. Beside her, unusually, stands Natasha (47) in a charcoal suit with a sheaf of memos.

NATASHA
Good morning. (beat) Happy new year. (beat) As part of our response to last month's Joint Commission survey, the Department of Surgery is adopting a new policy, effective today. (beat) Any attending, fellow or senior resident who is in a romantic relationship with a trainee in their reporting line must disclose it in writing to the program director, and the trainee will be reassigned out of that line. (beat) No exceptions. (beat) Including family.

She hands out the memo. Nobody looks at Esther. Everyone thinks about Esther.

NATASHA
(beat)
Dr. Smilley and Dr. Hartwell disclosed in November. (beat) They are in full compliance and have been since before this policy existed. (beat) I'm saying that out loud so nobody else has to whisper it.

ESTHER
(beat, quietly)
Thank you, Dr. Donohue.

NATASHA
(beat)
That's all. (beat) Dr. Bullock, they're yours.

Natasha leaves. Elxa takes over.

ELXA
(reading off)
Bullock, Smilley: Vascular, Dr. Moseley. He's got a pulsatile mass in the ER. (beat) Divine: Ortho. Ellison: Cardio step-down, your favorite patient. Baker: Peds cardiology, Kamari Fields's discharge. (beat) Cummings: me. (beat) Kennerly: your probation review is at twelve-thirty in the program director's office. (beat) Wear a tie.

KENNERLY
(beat)
I don't own a tie.

ELXA
(beat)
Then borrow one from somebody who likes you. (beat) Good luck.

6 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - BAY 5 - MORNING
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 7:19 AM

SILAS TILLMAN (85), tall and gaunt, in a three-piece suit, lies on a gurney, gray and sweating, a hand pressed to his back. His wife CORINTHIA TILLMAN (82), tiny, in a lavender hat with a veil, grips his other hand. DR. WENDELL MOSELEY (61), Chief of Vascular Surgery, white-haired and slow-talking, palpates Silas's abdomen. Marc and Esther stand beside him.

MOSELEY
(calm)
Feel that, Dr. Bullock.

Marc lays his hand on Silas's abdomen, just above the navel. Under his palm, a mass the size of a grapefruit pulses with every heartbeat, expanding sideways.

MARC
(beat)
Pulsatile. Expansile. (beat)
Abdominal aortic aneurysm.

CORINTHIA
(fierce)
He's had it since 2001. (beat)
Five centimeters, they said.
(beat) They said "watch it."
(beat) He stopped going to the
doctor in 2003, after his brother
died on the table.

SILAS
(weakly)
Corrie.

CORINTHIA
(beat)
Don't "Corrie" me. (beat) Back
pain since Sunday. (beat) He
didn't tell me until he couldn't
stand up in the shower.

ESTHER
(reading the
bedside ultrasound)
Seven-point-two centimeters.
(beat) Pressure one-ten over
seventy. (beat) No free fluid.
(beat) Not ruptured.

MOSELEY
(beat)
Not yet. (beat) Symptomatic
seven-centimeter aneurysm in an
eighty-five-year-old. (beat) He
needs it repaired today.

Corinthia looks up at the doctors. Under the veil, her eyes are wet.

CORINTHIA
(beat)
Today's our anniversary. (beat) Sixty years. (beat) January eleventh, 1946. Abyssinian. (beat) We were going to renew our vows at three o'clock this afternoon. (beat) Our grandchildren are flying in from Atlanta.

SILAS
(beat, smiling weakly)
I wore the suit.

MOSELEY
(beat, gently)
Mrs. Tillman. (beat) If we wait until three o'clock, he may not make it to three o'clock.

7 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - BAY 9 - MORNING
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 7:42 AM

KEISHA BOWMAN (38), a paralegal in an "I SURVIVED BOOT CAMP 2006" T-shirt, lies on a gurney, crying. Both of her calves are swollen, shiny and tense. A urine bag hanging on the rail holds liquid the color of Coca-Cola. Camille (29) presses a thumb into one calf. Harmony checks the labs.

KEISHA
(sobbing)
New Year's resolution. (beat) Twenty-eight-day spin boot camp in Forest Hills. (beat) Monday was the first day. (beat) Ninety minutes. (beat) The instructor said, "Pain is weakness leaving the body."

HARMONY
(reading)
CK is a hundred and twelve thousand. (beat) Potassium five-nine. (beat) Creatinine one-eight.

CAMILLE
(beat)
Rhabdomyolysis. (beat) Her muscles broke down and dumped myoglobin into her blood. (beat) It's clogging her kidneys. (beat) Choir, what else?

HARMONY
(beat, pressing the calf)
Her calves are like wood. (beat) Pain out of proportion. (beat) Pain with passive stretch of her toes. (beat) Compartment syndrome.

CAMILLE
(beat)
Both legs. (beat) Get me the Stryker needle. (beat) We measure the pressures, and then we probably cut.

KEISHA
(horrified)
Cut?

CAMILLE
(gently)
Fasciotomies, honey. (beat) We open the tight sleeves around your muscles so they can breathe. (beat) You'll have some scars. (beat) You'll keep your legs.

KEISHA
(beat)
I paid three hundred and ninety-nine dollars for this.

CAMILLE
(beat, dry)
Your lawyer's going to love that number.

8 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC STEP-DOWN - ROOM 609 - MORNING

WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 8:03 AM

Dash (34), thinner than at Christmas, sits in bed in his Carolina blue hoodie. A calendar on the wall: "DAY 61" circled in red marker. A tall, handsome woman in her late fifties, in a church coat, is unpacking a pound cake, a family photo and a quilt onto every surface: GLENDA DUVALL (58). Raven comes in with the vitals cart and stops.

DASH
(beat, sheepish)
Dr. Ellison. (beat) My mother.

GLENDA
(turning, appraising Raven head to toe)
So you're the one.

RAVEN
(beat)
The one who...?

GLENDA
(beat)
The one who gives haircuts. (beat) The one who flipped Christmas lights in Laurelton. (beat) The one my son talks about on the phone every Sunday until I have to tell him the long-distance rates went up.

DASH
(mortified)
Mama.

GLENDA
(beat, extending her hand)
Glenda Duvall. (beat) I took the Amtrak from Charlotte last night. (beat) Sixty-one days is long enough for a mother to wait.

RAVEN
(shaking it)
Mrs. Duvall. (beat) He's... (beat) He's a very good patient.

GLENDA
(beat, not letting go of her hand)
He's a terrible patient, baby. (beat) He's always been a terrible patient. (beat) But he's a very good man.

9 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PEDIATRIC CARDIOLOGY - ROOM 5 - MORNING

WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 8:31 AM

Kamari Fields (14), pink-lipped, dressed in street clothes, sits on the edge of the bed tying the laces of a pristine pair of limited-edition Christmas sneakers. Size nine and a half. Nadine packs his bag. Amond holds the discharge papers. Robert reviews the latest biopsy.

ROBERT
(reading)
Biopsy grade zero. No rejection. (beat) Tacrolimus level nine-point-two. (beat) Perfect.

AMOND
(handing Kamari a pill organizer)
Tacrolimus at eight a.m. and eight p.m. Mycophenolate twice a day. Prednisone in the morning. (beat) You miss one, you call me. (beat) You miss two, I come to your house.

KAMARI
(beat)
You don't know where I live.

AMOND
(beat)
168th Street, Jamaica. (beat) Third floor. (beat) Your mother put it on the form.

Kamari grins. He stands up in the new sneakers and looks down at them.

KAMARI
(beat)
Is Dash still upstairs?

AMOND
(beat)
Day sixty-one.

KAMARI
(beat)
Tell him I'm wearing them.

In the hallway afterward, Robert walks beside Amond.

ROBERT
(beat)
Dr. Baker. (beat) I have data on forty-two adolescent heart recipients at four New York centers since 1995. (beat) Adherence, rejection, graft survival. (beat) Nobody's written it up. (beat) I'd like you to be first author.

Amond stops walking.

AMOND
(beat)
Me.

ROBERT
(beat)
You spent five hours in December arguing with me about whether a boy would take his pills. (beat) Find out if you were right.

10 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - MORNING
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 9:02 AM

Natasha at her desk with Bassett (47) and DR. SYLVIA ROUNTREE (54), the CEO, elegant in a red suit. A thick curriculum vitae lies open on the desk: "MALCOLM SLOAN, M.D., F.A.C.S."

ROUNTREE
(beat)
Massachusetts General. Chief of Facial Plastics at thirty-four. Ninety-one publications. (beat) He rebuilt a Boston firefighter's face after a three-alarm fire in Dorchester. (beat) He's the best plastic surgeon on the East Coast, and he's willing to come to Queens. (beat) For less money.

NATASHA
(beat, reading)
Why?

ROUNTREE
(beat)
He says he wants to "rebuild something."

Natasha turns to the last page of the CV. References. Three names. The third: "Clayton Hartwell, M.D., Queens Grace Hospital."

NATASHA
(very still)
He listed Clayton Hartwell as a reference.

BASSETT
(beat, wincing)
Ah.

ROUNTREE
(beat)
Is that a problem?

Natasha closes the CV. She thinks of the Joint Commission, the firewall, the new policy she handed out an hour ago.

NATASHA
(beat, evenly)
He's the best plastic surgeon on the East Coast, Sylvia. (beat) Hire him. (beat) My department will manage whatever walks in with him.

ROUNTREE
(beat)
Start date?

NATASHA
(beat)
Whenever he likes. (beat) He's already in the building. (beat) He just hasn't arrived yet.

11 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - RADIOLOGY - CT SCANNER - MORNING

WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 9:17 AM

Silas Tillman on the CT table, sliding into the scanner. Marc at the control console with the tech. Esther beside him. Corinthia, in her lavender hat, waits by the door. On the monitor, slice after slice: a huge aneurysm. Then, along its left side, a hazy gray cloud spreading into the tissue behind the abdomen.

CT TECH
(beat)
What's that?

ESTHER
(beat, barely)
Retroperitoneal hematoma.

The monitor alarms. Silas's pressure: eighty-four. Seventy-six.

MARC
(into the intercom, fast)
Mr. Tillman, don't move. (beat, to the tech) Stop the scan. (beat, to Esther) He's rupturing.

Marc runs into the scanner room. Silas's face is ashen. He looks up at Marc and then past him to the door, where Corinthia stands frozen.

SILAS
(whispering)
Corrie.

CORINTHIA
(from the doorway, holding herself together by force)
I'm here, Silas. (beat) Sixty years. I'm right here.

MARC
(grabbing the phone)
Dr. Moseley. (beat) It's Bullock. (beat) He's rupturing in CT. (beat) OR 4. (beat) Now.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

12 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 4 - DAY
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 9:34 AM

Silas Tillman's abdomen, opened from the breastbone to the pubis. Blood fills the retroperitoneum. Moseley works with his hand deep in the wound. Marc retracts. Esther suctions. The anesthesiologist hangs blood as fast as it comes.

MOSELEY
(calm, slow, as though he's discussing the weather)
Supraceliac control. (beat) Dr. Bullock. Your fist. (beat) Right here, against the spine. (beat) Compress the aorta.

Marc drives his fist down through the bleeding, against the aorta above the aneurysm, and pushes with his whole weight. The bleeding slows.

MARC
(strained)
I have it.

MOSELEY
(beat)
Good. (beat) Hold it like a promise, son. (beat) Dr. Smilley, suction. Show me the neck.

Esther suctions. Moseley places a long aortic clamp above the aneurysm and closes it with a click.

MOSELEY
(beat)
Clamp's on. (beat) Let go, Dr. Bullock.

Marc slowly lifts his fist. The bleeding has stopped.

ANESTHESIOLOGIST
(beat)
Pressure's seventy, coming up. (beat) He's had six units.

MOSELEY
(beat)
Open the sac. (beat) Tube graft. Eighteen millimeter. (beat) We sew it in and we pray his kidneys forgive us.

Esther opens the aneurysm sac. Clot pours out of it, dark as tar. Moseley lays in the white Dacron graft.

MOSELEY
(sewing, slow)
Sixty years. (beat) Married on this date in 1946. (beat) I was married thirty-one years myself. (beat) Wanda passed in 2002. (beat) If somebody had told me then I'd have given my right hand for one more anniversary, I'd have said, "Take the left one too."

Marc and Esther glance at each other over the open abdomen.

MOSELEY
(beat)
You two. (beat) Sew faster than you talk.

13 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - BAY 9 - DAY
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 9:58 AM

Camille slides a pressure-monitor needle into Keisha's left calf. Harmony watches the digital readout. Keisha squeezes a nurse's hand, eyes shut.

HARMONY
(reading)
Anterior compartment, forty-eight. (beat) Diastolic is sixty-five. (beat) The delta pressure is seventeen.

CAMILLE
(beat)
Under thirty. (beat) Fasciotomy. (beat) The right leg?

HARMONY
(beat, after the needle goes in)
Fifty-one. (beat) Both legs, four compartments each.

CAMILLE
(to Keisha, gently)
Ms. Bowman, we're going to the operating room. (beat) Both legs. (beat) And then we're going to wash all that myoglobin out of your kidneys with a lot of IV fluid. (beat) You'll be with us for a week.

KEISHA
(beat, barely)
My boss is going to kill me.

CAMILLE
(beat)
Your spin instructor almost did. (beat) Your boss can wait his turn.

14 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - NURSES' STATION - DAY
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 10:27 AM

Elxa reviews a printout. Arianna stands across the counter from her. Elxa holds up the printout: the score report in the plastic sheet protector.

ELXA
(beat)
Somebody slid this under my office door at six-fifteen this morning.

ARIANNA
(beat)
I don't know anything about that.

ELXA
(beat)
Twenty-four over. (beat) I called the program director at home. (beat) Your PGY-2 contract will be in your box by Friday.

Arianna nods. Her face doesn't change. Her hands, at her sides, are shaking.

ELXA
(beat, quieter)
Cummings. (beat) In October, you came in here three points short and asked me for the ER so nobody would see you. (beat) You remember what I told you?

ARIANNA
(beat)
"Did I ask what you'd take?"

ELXA
(beat)
I sent you to Lowery because Lowery doesn't let anybody hide. (beat) And you didn't hide. (beat) Not once. (beat) That's the score I care about.

ARIANNA
(beat, barely)
Thank you, Dr. Bullock.

ELXA
(beat, going back to her charts)
Don't thank me. (beat) Go scrub in on something. (beat) And Cummings. (beat) Whoever made those purple cards? (beat) Buy her dinner.

ARIANNA
(beat)
She's buying me dinner.

ELXA
(beat, not looking up)
Then let her.

15 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC STEP-DOWN - ROOM 609 - DAY

WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 10:51 AM

Dash dozes. Glenda sits in the chair beside the bed with her knitting. Raven checks the milrinone pump. Glenda watches her the whole time.

GLENDA
(beat, quietly, so as not to wake him)
He had rheumatic fever at seven. (beat) Doctor said it might have scarred his heart. (beat) It didn't. (beat) Then at thirty-three it just started dying on him. (beat) For no reason. (beat) Idiopathic. (beat) I looked that word up in the library. (beat) It means "we don't know."

RAVEN
(beat)
It does.

GLENDA
(beat)
His father died at fifty-one. (beat) Heart attack. On the loading dock at the Philip Morris plant in Concord. (beat) I've buried one Duvall man with a bad heart, Dr. Ellison. (beat) I'm not burying another one.

RAVEN
(beat)
We're doing everything we can, Mrs. Duvall.

GLENDA
(beat, setting down her knitting)
I know you are. (beat) That's not what I'm worried about.

Raven looks up.

GLENDA
(beat)
My son is in love with you, baby. (beat) Sixty-one days in a bed, and you're the best part of every one of them. (beat) I just need to know you understand that.

Raven can't answer. Dash stirs in his sleep and murmurs something. Glenda pulls the quilt up over his shoulder.

16 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ELEVATOR - DAY
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 11:14 AM

Amond rides up, reading Robert's data spreadsheets. The doors open on seven. Whitlow (56) steps in, holding a thin binder labeled "EVIDENCE OF STANDARDS COMPLIANCE -- NPSG 8." The doors close. A long beat.

WHITLOW
(eyes on the numbers)
Dr. Baker.

AMOND
(eyes on his papers)
Dr. Whitlow.

WHITLOW
(beat)
It went to the Commission this morning. (beat) Four days early. (beat) The admission form has been live since December twenty-sixth. (beat) Pharmacy has reconciled every Medicine admission in under twenty-four hours.

AMOND
(beat)
How many have they caught?

WHITLOW
(beat)
Twenty-two. (beat) Duplicates. Missing home medications. Two drug interactions that would have put someone in the ICU. (beat) In sixteen days.

Amond lowers his papers. He looks at Whitlow. Whitlow keeps his eyes on the numbers.

WHITLOW
(beat, stiffly)
My chief resident wrote "Tate-Moore" on the top of the form. (beat) In the margin. (beat) Every copy. (beat) I didn't ask him to.

The doors open on nine. Whitlow steps out. He stops, and without turning around:

WHITLOW
(beat)
Thank you, Dr. Baker.

The doors close. Amond stands alone in the elevator, absolutely bewildered.

17 INT. MONTY'S ON JACKSON - BAR - DAY
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 11:38 AM

A slow late morning. Monty (43) behind the bar. Kennerly (27) sits alone on a stool, staring at a paper cup of coffee. Gloria Pettiford (53) comes in, in her coat, on her break. She stops when she sees him.

GLORIA
(beat)
Your review's at twelve-thirty.

KENNERLY
(beat)
Yes, ma'am.

GLORIA
(beat)
And you're sitting in a bar.

KENNERLY
(beat)
It's coffee. (beat) And I don't own a tie.

Gloria looks at him for a long moment. Then she opens her purse and takes out a narrow dark-blue silk tie, still in a department-store box.

GLORIA
(setting it on the bar)
My late husband's. (beat) Christmas, 2003. (beat) He never got to wear it.

KENNERLY
(staring at it)
Nurse Pettiford, I can't...

GLORIA
(beat)
You can, and you will. (beat) I wrote a letter to the program director yesterday. (beat) Two pages. (beat) About a cric in under ninety seconds, a turkey bone in an eighty-four-year-old woman and a boy who didn't ask for a seat at lunch. (beat) Don't make me a liar in a cheap shirt.

She walks out. Kennerly opens the box. Monty, wiping a glass, raises an eyebrow.

MONTY
(beat)
You want me to show you a Windsor knot?

KENNERLY
(beat, barely)
Yeah. (beat) Yeah, I do.

18 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 6 - DAY
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 11:55 AM

Keisha's legs on the table, both prepped. Camille makes long incisions on the inside and outside of the left calf. Purple-red muscle bulges out through the opened fascia like rising bread. Harmony works the right leg.

CAMILLE
(watching Harmony)
Medial incision two centimeters behind the tibia. (beat) Watch the saphenous vein. (beat) Open the superficial posterior. Then the deep. (beat) Don't miss the deep, Choir. Everybody misses the deep.

HARMONY
(concentrating)
Deep posterior's open. (beat) The muscle's pink. (beat) It's contracting.

CAMILLE
(beat, pleased)
She'll keep it. (beat) Good. (beat) Saturday.

HARMONY
(beat)
What about Saturday?

CAMILLE
(beat, eyes on her incision)
Papa got an apartment. (beat) FEMA voucher. A one-bedroom on Halsey Street in Bed-Stuy. (beat) He moves in Saturday. (beat) He called me last night and said, "Bring help."

HARMONY
(beat)
Help.

CAMILLE
(beat)
He said, "Bring help, Camille. Bring a friend with a truck." (beat) Then he hung up.

Harmony stops.

HARMONY
(beat)
A friend.

CAMILLE
(beat, quietly)
I don't know what he meant either, Choir. (beat) But my cousin's got a van.

HARMONY
(beat, going back to work)
My brothers have a truck.

19 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL ICU - BED 1 - DAY

WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 12:21 PM

Silas Tillman, fresh from the OR, intubated, gray, a forest of IV lines. Corinthia sits beside him in her lavender hat, holding his hand. Moseley reviews the monitor. Marc and Esther stand at the foot of the bed.

MOSELEY
(gently)
Mrs. Tillman. (beat) The graft is in. The bleeding has stopped. (beat) That's the good news.

CORINTHIA
(beat)
And the bad?

MOSELEY
(beat)
He lost a lot of blood before we clamped it. (beat) Eighty-five-year-old kidneys don't like that. (beat) Neither does an eighty-five-year-old heart. (beat) The next twenty-four hours will tell us. (beat) He may not wake up.

Corinthia looks at her husband for a long moment. She straightens his collar under the hospital gown, though there's no collar there.

CORINTHIA
(beat)
Our grandchildren land at LaGuardia at one-thirty. (beat) Reverend Montgomery is coming at three. (beat) I had a cake made. Lemon. (beat) He likes lemon.

MARC
(beat)
Mrs. Tillman...

CORINTHIA
(beat, firmly)
Dr. Bullock. (beat) Sixty years ago today, I married that man in a borrowed dress. (beat) Silas Tillman doesn't miss appointments. (beat) He'll wake up.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

20 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PROGRAM DIRECTOR'S OFFICE - DAY
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 12:32 PM

A small office. Behind the desk: the surgical PROGRAM DIRECTOR, DR. EUGENE PRATT (57). Beside him, Lowery and Elxa. Across from them sits Kennerly, in a crisp white shirt and Gloria's dark-blue silk tie, in a perfect Windsor knot.

DR. PRATT
(reading)
Dr. Kennerly. (beat) You were placed on academic probation on October eleventh for unprofessional conduct. (beat) The terms: ninety days, no complaints, a satisfactory evaluation from your supervising attending, and a written reflection. (beat) It's been ninety-two days.

KENNERLY
(beat)
Yes, sir.

DR. PRATT
(beat)
Dr. Lowery?

LOWERY
(beat)
He's competent. (beat) Better than competent. (beat) He did a cricothyrotomy in under ninety seconds and a Magill extraction on Thanksgiving. (beat) He is not always pleasant. (beat) He is always honest. (beat) I'll take honest.

DR. PRATT
Dr. Bullock?

ELXA
(beat, flat)
He's a pain in my neck. (beat) He's also stopped being a pain in my patients' necks. (beat) Lift it.

Dr. Pratt picks up a two-page letter.

DR. PRATT
(beat)
And I have a letter from Nurse Gloria Pettiford, R.N. (beat) In twenty years as program director, I have never once received a letter from Gloria Pettiford in support of a surgical intern. (beat) Only against.

Kennerly looks down at the tie.

DR. PRATT
(beat)
Probation is lifted, effective today. (beat) Congratulations, Dr. Kennerly.

KENNERLY
(beat, barely)
Thank you, sir.

ELXA
(beat, standing)
Don't thank him. (beat) Thank the tie.

21 INT. CLAYTON'S OFFICE - L&D - DAY
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 1:04 PM

A small office lined with fetal echo images. Clayton (34) at his desk. Esther stands in the doorway, white-faced, holding a copy of the new disclosure memo.

ESTHER
(beat)
Malcolm listed you as a reference.

Clayton looks up. He doesn't deny it.

ESTHER
(beat)
Dr. Donohue told me. (beat) In the stairwell. (beat) Not because she had to. Because she didn't want me to find out in a hallway.

CLAYTON
(beat, standing)
Esther...

ESTHER
(beat)
When did he ask you?

CLAYTON
(beat)
October. (beat) Before Thanksgiving. (beat) Before the voicemail. (beat) Rountree's office called me in November to confirm. (beat) I told them he's the best plastic surgeon I've ever seen.

ESTHER
(beat, shaking)
You gave the man who slept with you a reference to come work in my building.

CLAYTON
(beat, quietly)
I told the truth about his hands, Esther. (beat) I've never lied about anyone's hands.

ESTHER
(beat)
You told me no decisions in this marriage without me in the room. (beat) Session eight. (beat) You said that on Montague Street.

CLAYTON
(beat)
I said that in November. (beat) The reference was October.

ESTHER
(beat, very quiet)
Then you should have told me in November.

She turns and walks out. Clayton stands at his desk, surrounded by images of hearts that aren't born yet.

22 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC STEP-DOWN - ROOM 609 - DAY
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 1:33 PM

Dash is awake now, sitting up. Glenda has gone to the cafeteria. Raven sits in Glenda's chair. Between them on the tray table: a slice of Glenda's pound cake on a paper plate.

DASH
(beat)
My mama said something to you. (beat) I can see it on your face.

RAVEN
(beat)
She loves you.

DASH
(beat)
She told you I'm in love with you.

Raven doesn't answer.

DASH
(beat, softly)
She's not wrong, Doctor. (beat) I'm not going to pretend she's wrong. (beat) I'm on day sixty-one with a cantaloupe for a heart. (beat) I don't have time to pretend things.

RAVEN
(beat, barely)
Dash. (beat) I'm with somebody.

DASH
(beat)
The intern with the purple cards. (beat) I know. (beat) The night nurses.

RAVEN
(beat)
She passed her boards this morning. (beat) I'm taking her to dinner tonight.

DASH
(beat, smiling, and it costs him)
Then go to dinner, Raven. (beat) Order the octopus. (beat) I'll be right here. (beat) That's the one thing I'm good at.

He's called her Raven for the first time. She hears it. She stands up and leaves the pound cake.

23 EXT. 168TH STREET - JAMAICA, QUEENS - DAY
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 1:58 PM

A three-story walk-up on a busy Jamaica block. Kamari, in a coat, a surgical mask over his face per transplant rules, climbs out of a livery cab in his limited-edition sneakers. Nadine pays the driver. On the third-floor window, a hand-painted bedsheet hangs from the fire escape: "WELCOME HOME KAMARI." Neighbors on the stoop cheer. A little girl runs up and hugs his legs.

Kamari looks down at the sneakers. He takes out a disposable camera, crouches and snaps a picture of his own feet on the sidewalk.

NADINE
(beat)
What's that for, baby?

KAMARI
(beat)
For Dash. (beat) So he can see them on a sidewalk.

24 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL B - DAY
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 2:22 PM

Natasha comes down the stairs. Esther sits on the landing, her knees pulled up, the memo crumpled in her hand. Natasha sits down beside her, which the Chief of Surgery has never once done with an intern in a stairwell.

NATASHA
(beat)
Dr. Smilley. (beat) I'm going to ask you a question as your Chief. (beat) Not as anything else.

ESTHER
(beat)
Yes, ma'am.

NATASHA
(beat)
Is Dr. Sloan's appointment a problem for your training?

Esther thinks about it. Then she lifts her chin.

ESTHER
(beat)
If he's the best plastic surgeon on the East Coast, Dr. Donohue, hire him. (beat) My patients deserve the best. (beat) My training is my problem. (beat) Not his. (beat) Not yours.

Natasha looks at her for a long moment.

NATASHA
(beat)
That's the answer of a chief, Dr. Smilley. (beat) Not an intern.

ESTHER
(beat, wiping her eyes)
It's the answer of a hardware store owner's daughter from Mattapan. (beat) You sell what's good. (beat) Even to people you hate.

25 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL ICU - BED 1 - DAY

WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 2:51 PM

The bay is crowded with family: two adult sons in suits, a daughter, four grandchildren in their Sunday best, fresh from LaGuardia. A lemon sheet cake on the counter. REVEREND DR. ELIAS MONTGOMERY (68), an associate pastor from Abyssinian, in his robes. Corinthia sits beside Silas, holding his hand. Marc and Esther are at the monitor.

Silas's eyelids flutter. His fingers move in Corinthia's hand.

CORINTHIA
(leaning in)
Silas. (beat) Silas Tillman.

His eyes open. Unfocused. Then they find her face. The tube is still in his mouth. He can't speak. But he squeezes her hand. Once. Twice.

CORINTHIA
(beat, a sob of joy)
I told you. (beat) I told them all. (beat) He doesn't miss appointments.

The family breaks into tears. One of the grandchildren starts singing "Blessed Assurance." Marc looks at Esther across the bed.

MARC
(quietly, to Moseley at the door)
Dr. Moseley. (beat) It's two-fifty-one. (beat) The vows were at three.

MOSELEY
(beat, a slow smile spreading across his face)
Then I suppose we'd better clear some floor space, Dr. Bullock.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

26 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL ICU - BED 1 - DAY
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 3:00 PM

The nurses have pushed back the curtains. The family crowds in. Nurses and residents gather at the edges. Reverend Montgomery, in his robes, stands at the head of the bed. Corinthia, in her lavender hat, holds Silas's hand. Silas, still intubated, is awake, his eyes fixed on his wife. Moseley stands by the monitor. Marc and Esther stand together at the foot of the bed.

REV. MONTGOMERY
(gently)
Sixty years ago today, in the sanctuary of Abyssinian Baptist Church, Silas and Corinthia Tillman made promises before God. (beat) Today, in the sanctuary of an intensive care unit, they've asked to make them again.

Corinthia lifts her veil.

CORINTHIA
(steady, looking only at Silas)
Silas Tillman. (beat) You came home from Okinawa with a limp and a ring in your pocket. (beat) You worked thirty-eight years for the Transit Authority. (beat) You buried our baby girl with me in 1951, and you never once let me carry it alone. (beat) I've loved you every day for sixty years. (beat) Some days I didn't like you. (beat) I loved you anyway. (beat) I'd do every one of them again.

The grandchildren are crying. Reverend Montgomery turns to Silas.

REV. MONTGOMERY
(beat)
Silas. (beat) Do you take Corinthia again, from this day forward, for as long as you both shall live?

Silas can't speak. He looks at Corinthia. Then, slowly, deliberately, he blinks. Once. Then he lifts their joined hands an inch off the blanket and brings them down.

CORINTHIA
(laughing through tears)
That's a yes. (beat) Sixty years, that's what yes looks like.

Moseley, by the monitor, takes out a handkerchief and blows his nose loudly. Marc glances at Esther. She's crying too. Without thinking, he takes her hand. She lets him hold it for exactly as long as the hymn the family begins to sing. Then she lets go.

27 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL WARD - ROOM 422 - DAY
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 5:14 PM

Keisha Bowman lies in bed with both legs wrapped in bulky dressings over open fasciotomy wounds, an IV running wide open, a Foley bag filling slowly with pink urine that's lighter than this morning's. Harmony checks the bag. The door opens. A tanned, muscled man in a fleece vest with a "PEAK FITNESS" logo comes in holding a bouquet of grocery-store carnations: the spin instructor, TROY DANIELS (31).

TROY
(bright)
Keisha! (beat) Hey, champ. (beat) The whole six a.m. class signed a card.

Keisha stares at him. Harmony steps between Troy and the bed.

HARMONY
(pleasantly)
Mr. Daniels. (beat) Do you know what a creatine kinase of a hundred and twelve thousand means?

TROY
(beat)
Uh. (beat) She worked hard?

HARMONY
(beat)
It means her muscles dissolved into her bloodstream and almost shut down her kidneys. (beat) It means my attending had to cut both of her legs open from knee to ankle this morning. (beat) "Pain is weakness leaving the body," Mr. Daniels?

TROY
(beat, pale)
It's... it's a saying.

HARMONY
(beat)
So is "you have the right to remain silent." (beat) Her lawyer's going to want a copy of your waiver form.

Troy sets the carnations down on the chair very carefully, as if they might explode, and backs out of the room. Keisha starts to laugh, then winces and holds her side.

KEISHA
(beat)
You're scary, Dr. Divine.

HARMONY
(beat, checking the urine bag)
Only on Wednesdays. (beat) Your kidneys are clearing, Ms. Bowman. (beat) Look. (beat) Pink lemonade.

KEISHA
(beat, softly)
New Year's resolution was to get strong. (beat) I guess I'll start with walking.

HARMONY
(beat)
Start with walking. (beat) And find a teacher who knows the difference between strong and hurt.

28 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC STEP-DOWN - ROOM 609 - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 5:41 PM

Raven, in her coat, a gift bag in her hand, stops at Dash's door to say goodnight. Dash is laughing at something Glenda said. He looks up.

DASH
(grinning)
Look at you. (beat) Go get that octopus, Doctor. (beat) Tell Problem I said...

He stops. His face goes blank. His eyes roll up. On the monitor: a wide, fast, chaotic rhythm. Ventricular tachycardia. Two hundred and ten. Dash slumps against the pillow.

GLENDA
(standing)
Darius!

A thump. Dash's whole body jerks as his implanted defibrillator fires. The monitor scribbles, then settles.

Sinus rhythm. Ninety-eight. Dash gasps and opens his eyes.

DASH
(dazed)
Somebody kicked me. (beat)
Somebody kicked me in the chest
with a horse.

Raven has already dropped the gift bag. She's at the bedside with her fingers on his pulse, her eyes on the monitor.

RAVEN
(calling out the
door)
I need a twelve-lead and stat
lytes and mag! (beat) Page Dr.
Bullock! (beat) His ICD just
fired!

The monitor alarms again. V-tach. Another thump. Dash cries out. Glenda covers her mouth.

RAVEN
(taking his hand,
steady)
Dash. Look at me. (beat) Look at
me. (beat) I'm not going
anywhere.

29 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - NURSES' STATION - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 6:02 PM

Elxa signs out, both hands pressed into the small of her back. Natasha stands across the counter with a calendar.

NATASHA
(beat)
Thirty-six weeks on Saturday.
(beat) Your maternity leave
starts the twenty-third.

ELXA
(not looking up)
No.

NATASHA
(beat)
Elxa.

ELXA
(beat)
I'll work until he comes, Mama. (beat) That's what you did. (beat) You told me yourself. (beat) Twice.

NATASHA
(beat)
I did. (beat) And in 1979 I went into labor with your brother on the steps of Widener Library, alone, because I was too proud to stop. (beat) A security guard named Alphonse caught me.

ELXA
(beat, stopping)
You never told me that.

NATASHA
(beat)
I've never told anybody that. (beat) Desk duty from the thirtieth. (beat) No OR, no codes, no stairs. (beat) You can run the board from a chair. (beat) That's my offer. (beat) Take it, or I'll tell Russell about Alphonse.

ELXA
(beat, grudging)
The thirtieth.

NATASHA
(beat)
The thirtieth.

30 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 5 - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 6:24 PM

Dash, transferred to CVICU, pale, an amiodarone drip running, pads on his chest. Glenda sits by the bed, holding his hand, her lips moving in prayer. Robert reviews the strips with Raven at the glass.

ROBERT
(beat)
Two shocks. (beat) Electrical storm. (beat) Amiodarone, lidocaine, potassium four-point-five, magnesium two. (beat) He's stable for now.

RAVEN
(beat)
For now.

ROBERT
(beat, quietly)
Dr. Ellison. (beat) His heart is telling us it won't wait much longer. (beat) If he storms again, we talk about putting in a left ventricular assist device. (beat) A bridge. (beat) Until a heart comes.

RAVEN
(beat)
Like Mr. Teague.

ROBERT
(beat)
Like Mr. Teague. (beat) But Mr. Teague's pump is his destination. (beat) Mr. Duvall's pump would be a bridge. (beat) A bridge is only good if there's something on the other side.

Raven looks through the glass at Dash. He's watching her, and he smiles weakly and lifts two fingers off the sheet. Robert looks at Raven's coat, her bag, the gift bag she left on the floor in 609.

ROBERT
(beat, gently)
You were going somewhere tonight.

RAVEN
(beat)
Dinner.

ROBERT
(beat)
Then go. (beat) The CVICU nurses have him. (beat) I have him.

RAVEN
(beat, not moving)
I'll go in a minute.

31 INT. TAVERNA KYCLADES - DITMARS BOULEVARD, ASTORIA - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 7:16 PM

A bright, loud Greek taverna. Blue-and-white walls, fishing nets, families at long tables. Arianna sits alone at a table for two by the window, dressed up for once: a black sweater, earrings. A plate of grilled octopus sits untouched in front of her. A second glass of wine across the table, untouched too. Her phone is face up beside her plate. It doesn't ring.

A waiter comes by.

WAITER
(beat, kindly)
Still waiting, miss?

ARIANNA
(beat, flat)
She's a surgeon. (beat) They're always late.

The waiter leaves. Arianna picks up the phone and looks at it. Nothing. She sets it down again, exactly parallel to the edge of the table.

32 INT. TAVERNA KYCLADES - DITMARS BOULEVARD, ASTORIA - NIGHT

WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 8:04 PM

The octopus is cold. Arianna puts two twenties on the table, puts on her coat, and picks up her phone. She types with her thumb.

SMS: "congratulations to me."

She sends it. She walks out into the cold of Ditmars Boulevard, past the windows of the families still eating, and doesn't look back.

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

33 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 5 - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 8:09 PM

Raven sits beside Dash. He's asleep. Glenda has gone to find coffee. Raven's phone buzzes in her coat pocket. She takes it out and reads the text. Her face collapses.

RAVEN
(whispering)
Oh, no. (beat) Oh, no, no, no.

She looks at the clock on the wall: 8:09. She looks at Dash, asleep. She stands up, grabs her bag and runs.

34 INT. MONTY'S ON JACKSON - BAR - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 8:22 PM

The bar is busy. Kennerly, still in Gloria's tie, sits at the bar between Marc and Amond. Monty sets down three shots of bourbon.

MONTY
(beat)
On the house. (beat) Ninety-two days. (beat) I've watched three interns go on probation in this hospital, and you're the first one I've seen get off it with a better knot than he went in with.

KENNERLY
(beat)
Nurse Pettiford's husband's tie.

AMOND
(beat)
She gave you her dead husband's tie.

KENNERLY
(beat, staring at the shot)
Christmas 2003. (beat) He never wore it. (beat) I don't know what to do with that.

MARC
(beat)
Wear it.

Kennerly picks up his shot. He hesitates.

KENNERLY
(beat, not looking at Marc)
Bullock. (beat) In September. (beat) I said a lot of things.

MARC
(beat)
You did.

KENNERLY
(beat)
I'm still not apologizing.

MARC
(beat)
I know.

KENNERLY
(beat)
But I was wrong. (beat) About why you're good. (beat) For the record.

A beat. The three of them drink. Amond sets his glass down.

AMOND
(beat, dry)
That was almost an apology.

KENNERLY
(beat)
It was a correction. (beat)
There's a difference.

35 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PLASTIC SURGERY SUITE - CORRIDOR - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 8:37 PM

A quiet, newly painted corridor. Esther, in her coat, takes the long way out. She stops. At the end of the hall, a maintenance worker on a stepladder is screwing a brass nameplate to the door of a corner office. She stands and reads it from a distance.

"MALCOLM SLOAN, M.D., F.A.C.S. -- CHIEF, DIVISION OF PLASTIC AND RECONSTRUCTIVE SURGERY."

The worker tightens the last screw, climbs down and folds his ladder.

MAINTENANCE WORKER
(passing her, friendly)
New guy starts in February.
(beat) Big shot from Boston.
(beat) You know him?

ESTHER
(beat, barely)
I used to.

36 INT. CLAYTON'S SUBLET - BROOKLYN HEIGHTS - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 9:12 PM

Clayton sits on the sofa, his tie loose, a glass of water on the coffee table. Esther comes in, takes off her coat and sits at the other end of the sofa.

ESTHER
(beat)
They put up his nameplate. (beat)
Tonight. (beat) Corner office.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Esther. (beat) I should have told you in November. (beat) I'm telling you all of it now. (beat) He called me in October at two in the morning. (beat) Drunk. From his car, outside your mother's house. (beat) He said, "I want to be where she is, even if she never speaks to me." (beat) He asked me to say he was good. (beat) He is good. (beat) So I said it.

Esther is quiet for a long time.

ESTHER
(beat)
No more Octobers, Clayton.

CLAYTON
(beat)
What does that mean?

ESTHER
(beat)
It means the next time something happens that I'll find out about later, you tell me the same day. (beat) Even at two in the morning. (beat) Even drunk. (beat) No more Octobers.

CLAYTON
(beat, quietly)
No more Octobers.

She doesn't move closer. But she doesn't leave the sofa either.

37 EXT. ARIANNA'S BUILDING - 30TH AVENUE, ASTORIA - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 9:34 PM

The bakery downstairs is dark. Raven, out of breath, her coat open, rings the buzzer. Nothing. She rings again. The upstairs window opens. Arianna leans out in her Pitt sweatshirt.

ARIANNA
(flat)
It's nine-thirty.

RAVEN
(beat, looking up)
His ICD fired. (beat) Twice. (beat) Electrical storm. (beat) I was standing in his doorway in my coat with your present in my hand, and his heart stopped.

ARIANNA
(beat)
I know.

RAVEN
(beat)
You know?

ARIANNA
(beat)
Bullock called me at eight-thirty from Monty's. (beat) He said, "Before you hate her, you should know where she was."

Raven stands on the sidewalk, looking up.

ARIANNA
(beat, quieter)
That's the problem, Raven. (beat) I know where you were. (beat) I'd have stayed too. (beat) Any doctor would have stayed. (beat) I'm not mad you stayed. (beat) I'm mad that, while you were staying, you didn't think about me even once.

RAVEN
(beat, barely)
That's not true.

ARIANNA
(beat)
What time did you look at your phone?

RAVEN
(beat)
Eight-oh-nine.

A long silence. The window stays open. Then the door buzzer sounds.

ARIANNA
(beat, from the window)
I brought the octopus home. (beat) It's terrible cold. (beat) Come up.

38 INT. CAMILLE'S APARTMENT - JACKSON HEIGHTS - KITCHEN - NIGHT

WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 9:52 PM

Camille and Harmony at the small kitchen table with a takeout container of jambalaya between them. A notepad: "SATURDAY. HALSEY ST." with a list underneath. "BED. TABLE. 2 CHAIRS. PHOTO OF HOTEL. ROSARY ON NIGHTSTAND?"

HARMONY
(beat)
Jerry and Ronnie have the truck at eight. (beat) They said they'd carry everything, including your father, if he's difficult.

CAMILLE
(beat, laughing)
He'll be difficult.

HARMONY
(beat)
Camille. (beat) What do I say when he sees me?

Camille stops laughing. She thinks.

CAMILLE
(beat)
You say, "Good morning, Mr. Toussaint." (beat) And you carry a box. (beat) That's all, Choir. (beat) He asked for a friend with a truck. (beat) We bring him one. (beat) And we let him decide what he sees.

HARMONY
(beat)
And if he sends me home?

CAMILLE
(beat, reaching for her hand)
Then you leave the truck. (beat) And I come with you.

39 INT. NATASHA AND ROBERT'S BROWNSTONE - RIVERSIDE DRIVE - BEDROOM - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 10:18 PM

Natasha in bed with Malcolm Sloan's CV on her lap. Robert comes out of the bathroom in pajamas and sits on the edge of the bed.

ROBERT
(beat)
The Duvall boy stormed tonight. (beat) Two shocks. (beat) He's not going to last on the list much longer. (beat) Your intern is in love with him. (beat) Ellison.

NATASHA
(beat, not looking up)
I know.

ROBERT
(beat)
You know everything.

NATASHA
(beat)
I know about this. (beat) Sylvia hired Malcolm Sloan today. (beat) February. (beat) He listed Clayton as a reference.

Robert takes off his reading glasses.

ROBERT
(beat)
In the same building as Smilley.

NATASHA
(beat)
In the same building as Smilley. (beat) And Clayton. (beat) And our son, who looks at Smilley the way you looked at me in 1976.

ROBERT
(beat, dry)
Somebody's going to throw a punch, Tasha.

NATASHA
(closing the CV)
Somebody always does, Robert. (beat) I just pray it's not in an operating room.

40 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL ICU - BED 1 - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 10:47 PM

The family has gone to a hotel. Only Corinthia remains, asleep in the chair beside Silas, her lavender hat in her

lap. A slice of lemon cake on a paper plate rests on the tray table, one bite taken out of it. Marc, on his last check, adjusts the IV. Silas is awake, watching his wife sleep.

Marc looks at the old man. Silas raises one hand weakly off the sheet and points at the cake, then at himself.

MARC
(softly)
Not yet, Mr. Tillman. (beat) Tomorrow. (beat) When the tube's out.

Silas looks at him. Then he lowers his hand and closes it gently around his wife's sleeping fingers.

TAG

41 INT. ARIANNA'S APARTMENT - ABOVE THE BAKERY - ASTORIA - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 11:39 PM

Raven and Arianna sit cross-legged on the bed, eating cold grilled octopus out of a takeout box with their fingers. The score report, in its plastic sheet protector, leans against the lamp. Raven's gift bag, recovered from the floor of 609, lies open: a small silver keychain shaped like a kidney.

ARIANNA
(holding it up)
A kidney.

RAVEN
(beat)
Renal. (beat) You said renal was the hardest.

ARIANNA
(beat, putting her keys on it right there)
It's the ugliest thing I've ever owned. (beat) Thank you.

MARC (V.O.)
Every January, the whole world makes the same promise.

42 EXT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - STOOP - NIGHT
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 11, 2006 - 11:58 PM

Marc sits on the stoop. Mercy, four months old, sits beside him, leaning her whole weight against his leg. The Manhattan skyline glitters across the river.

MARC (V.O.)
A brand-new day. A clean page.

Marc rubs Mercy's ears. She sighs.

MARC (V.O.)
But a new year doesn't erase anything. (beat) It just hands you the same people, the same hearts, the same old wounds. (beat) And asks you what you're going to do with them this time.

Across the river, a single light goes off in a tower.

MARC (V.O.)
That's the only promise worth making. (beat) Not that you'll be different. (beat) That you'll show up.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 2x13

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

ASSOCIATED PRESS: "ALITO HEARINGS ENTER THIRD DAY" / "SHARON REMAINS IN COMA"

Wednesday, January 11, 2006

"WASHINGTON (AP) -- Supreme Court nominee Samuel Alito faced a third day of questioning before the Senate Judiciary Committee..." / "JERUSALEM (AP) -- Israeli Prime Minister Ariel Sharon remained in a medically induced coma one week after a massive stroke..." Also: West Virginia mourned the 12 miners killed in the January 2 Sago Mine explosion.

QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL -- Department of Surgery Memorandum S-06-01

Effective January 11, 2006

"RELATIONSHIPS WITHIN THE TRAINING HIERARCHY. Any attending, fellow or senior resident in a romantic or familial relationship with a trainee in their reporting line must disclose it in writing to the Program Director. The trainee will be reassigned outside that reporting line. No exceptions. -- N. Donohue, M.D., Chief of Surgery"

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Wednesday, January 11, 2006, 5:10 PM

"VOWS IN THE ICU. An 85-year-old ruptured his aorta in CT this morning, got a new one by noon, and renewed his wedding vows at THREE O'CLOCK SHARP with a breathing tube in. He said yes by blinking. We have never been more emotionally destroyed by a vascular case. Also: a certain intern got off probation today wearing a tie the whole ER recognizes. And a brass nameplate went up in Plastics tonight. Big name from Boston. Start date February. We have QUESTIONS." Comments (2,244).

NBME score report (excerpt): Arianna Cummings

Posted Wednesday, January 11, 2006

"USMLE Step 2 Clinical Knowledge. Test date: December 12, 2005. RESULT: PASS." (Twenty-four points above the minimum. Arianna slid a copy, in a plastic sheet protector, under Elxa's door at 6:15 AM.)

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Arianna Cummings to Raven Ellison)

Wednesday, January 11, 2006, 8:04 PM

Arianna: "congratulations to me."

Brass nameplate, Plastic Surgery Suite, Queens Grace

Installed Wednesday, January 11, 2006, 8:37 PM

"MALCOLM SLOAN, M.D., F.A.C.S. -- CHIEF, DIVISION OF PLASTIC AND RECONSTRUCTIVE SURGERY"

Continuity Sheet: Episode 2x13

New Canon Established

- **ARIANNA PASSED STEP 2 CK** (24 points above the line; scores posted Wednesday, January 11). Elxa called the program director, and **her PGY-2 contract is in her box by Friday.** Elxa: 'You didn't hide. Not once.' Raven's dinner at Taverna Kyclades on Ditmars (7 PM) went badly: **Raven never arrived** because Dash's ICD fired twice at 5:41 PM. She didn't look at her phone until 8:09. Arianna texted 'congratulations to me.' Marc called Arianna at 8:30 to tell her where Raven was. Arianna: 'I'm mad that, while you were staying, you didn't think about me even once.' They ate cold octopus at 11:39 PM, and Raven gave her a silver kidney keychain.
- **MALCOLM SLOAN IS COMING TO QUEENS GRACE** as Chief of Plastic and Reconstructive Surgery, starting in **February 2006**. Dr. Rountree recruited him; he interviewed in November. He's ex-MGH, Chief of Facial Plastics at 34, with 91 publications. He told Esther on Christmas Eve on Corinne's porch, after the dinner (rule one held; Corinne made him say grace, and he couldn't finish). **He listed Clayton as a reference.** Clayton gave it in October and confirmed it in November without telling Esther. Malcolm had called Clayton drunk at 2 AM outside Corinne's: 'I want to be where she is.' Esther: 'No more Octobers.' Esther told Natasha: 'Hire him if he's the best.' His nameplate went up at 8:37 PM.
- **New Department of Surgery policy** (Memo S-06-01, January 11): relationships within a reporting line must be disclosed and the trainee reassigned. Natasha publicly confirmed that Esther and Clayton have complied since November. Natasha and Robert expect 'somebody's going to throw a punch.'
- **Dash Duvall, day 61:** his mother **Glenda Duvall** (58) arrived from Charlotte by Amtrak. His father died at 51 of a heart attack on the loading dock at the Philip Morris plant in Concord, NC. Dash had rheumatic fever at seven, and his cardiomyopathy is idiopathic. Glenda told Raven: 'My son is in love with you.' **Dash told Raven he loves her and first called her 'Raven.'** Raven: 'I'm with somebody.' **An electrical storm (two ICD shocks) moved him to the CVICU** on amiodarone and lidocaine. Robert raised an **LVAD as a bridge** if he storms again.
- **Kennerly's probation was lifted** (92 days) on recommendations from Lowery, Elxa and a two-page letter from Gloria, the first Gloria has ever written *for* an intern. Gloria gave him her late husband's never-worn Christmas 2003 tie, and Monty taught him a Windsor knot. To Marc: 'I was wrong. About why you're good. It was a correction.'
- **Robert offered Amond first authorship** on a study of 42 adolescent heart recipients at four New York centers since 1995. **Whitlow thanked Amond** in the elevator. The NPSG 8 Evidence of Standards Compliance went in four days early, the form has been live since December 26, and pharmacy caught 22 errors in 16 days. Whitlow's chief resident wrote 'Tate-Moore' in the margin of every copy. Kamari went home to 168th Street in Jamaica in Dash's sneakers and photographed them on the sidewalk for Dash.
- **Elxa's leave:** desk duty from January 30. Natasha revealed she **went into labor with Marc on the steps of Widener Library in January 1979** and was caught by a guard named Alphonse; she has never told anyone else. Marc's Christmas in Brookline had 34 Donohues; Joan fed Mercy off the good china: 'Everyone at this table is a rescue, Victor Junior.' **Augustin moves**

into a FEMA-voucher one-bedroom on Halsey Street, Bed-Stuy, on Saturday, January 14, and asked Camille to 'bring a friend with a truck.' Jerry and Ronnie are bringing the truck.

- **The Tillmans** renewed their vows in the SICU at 3:00 PM, the 60th anniversary of their January 11, 1946 wedding at Abyssinian. Silas said yes by blinking. Marc held Esther's hand during the hymn, and she let go when it ended. Moseley's wife Wanda died in 2002.

Knowledge Tracker (as of January 11, 2006)

Item	Who knows
Malcolm hired at QGH	Natasha, Rountree, Bassett, Robert, Esther, Clayton, Marc; the blog (no name)
Malcolm and Clayton's affair	Esther, Clayton, Malcolm, Marc, Dr. Greenidge (Natasha suspects)
Dash loves Raven	Dash, Glenda, Raven, Arianna, Robert
Natasha's Widener Library labor	Elxa only
Heir designation; Robert and Delphine Ware	Still secret

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Silas Tillman	9/2/1920 (85)	7.2 cm symptomatic AAA, ruptured in CT (retroperitoneal)	Open repair, 18 mm tube graft; supraceliac compression by Bullock (Moseley; Bullock; Smilley)	Awake; vows renewed; ICU
Keisha Bowman	10/9/1967 (38)	Exertional rhabdomyolysis (CK 112,000), bilateral calf compartment syndrome	Four-compartment fasciotomies, both legs (Toussaint; Divine)	Muscle viable; IV fluids for her kidneys
Darius 'Dash' Duvall	8/8/1971 (34)	DCM, Status 1A; VT storm with two ICD shocks	Amiodarone and lidocaine; CVICU (R. Bullock; Ellison)	Stable; LVAD bridge discussed
Kamari Fields	4/24/1991 (14)	Heart transplant recipient	Biopsy grade 0; discharge (R. Bullock; Baker)	Home

New Characters

- **Dr. Wendell Moseley** (b. August 25, 1944), Chief of Vascular Surgery, widower. **Dr. Eugene Pratt** (b. November 14, 1948), Surgical Program Director (20 years). **Glenda Duvall** (b. December 12, 1947). **Dr. Sylvia Rountree**, on-screen debut (in MA-005).
- **Silas Tillman** (b. September 2, 1920; WWII Okinawa veteran; 38 years with the Transit Authority) and **Corinthia Tillman** (b. May 15, 1923), married January 11, 1946; their daughter died in 1951. **Keisha Bowman** (b. October 9, 1967), a paralegal. **Rev. Dr. Elias Montgomery** (b. June 30, 1937).

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- On January 11, 2006, the Alito confirmation hearings were in their third day, Ariel Sharon had been comatose since his January 4 stroke, and the January 2 Sago Mine explosion had killed 12 miners (one survivor). USMLE scores are customarily released on Wednesdays. Widener

Library is Harvard's main library. FEMA rental assistance housed many Katrina evacuees in New York.

- Medicine: AAA repair is indicated above 5.5 cm or when symptomatic. A ruptured AAA with a retroperitoneal hematoma can be temporized with supraceliac compression and repaired with a Dacron tube graft. Renal and cardiac complications are common in octogenarians. Exertional rhabdomyolysis from 'boot camp' spin classes causes myoglobinuric kidney injury and compartment syndrome; fasciotomy is indicated when the delta pressure (diastolic minus compartment) is under 30 mmHg. An 'electrical storm' is three or more VT/VF episodes in 24 hours (here two shocks within minutes), treated with amiodarone, lidocaine and electrolyte repletion. An LVAD can bridge a deteriorating 1A candidate to transplant.